全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 20 單元 | 自然與動物 · Nature & Animals

Where the Pines Meet the Stars

松樹與星星相遇之處

Few places in Taiwan feel as far from the city as the Hehuanshan area after dark. By day, the slopes are crowded with hikers taking photos of the scenery; by night, the trail belongs to the wildlife. The pines stand black against a sky in which thousands of stars twinkle, and the only sounds are the wind and, now and then, the call of an owl hunting from a high branch.

The wilderness here is home to more species than most visitors imagine. Sambar deer wander across the meadows in small herds, their eyes shining in the moonlight. A squirrel may dart up a trunk at the sound of footsteps, and moths as large as a child's palm gather around any headlamp left on too long. Scientists have recorded over two hundred kinds of birds in the region, including the rare Mikado pheasant, which is found nowhere else on Earth.

Walking the trail at night requires care. The path is covered with loose pebbles, and the soil on the steeper slopes turns slippery after rain. Some plants with pretty purple petals are poisonous, and the thick webs stretched between the trees belong to spiders that hikers are advised not to touch. Guides remind visitors to follow their map rather than their instinct, because every ridge looks the same in the dark.

Yet those who make the effort are rewarded at dawn. As the sun rises over the eastern peaks, the Pacific appears as a thin silver line beyond the mountains, and the whole valley fills with birdsong. For a few minutes, before the first tour bus arrives, the mountain seems to belong to no one, or perhaps to everyone. It is a reminder that Taiwan's wildest places are only a few hours from its busiest streets, and that they survive only as long as we leave them untamed.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
slope	*n.*	斜坡；山坡	The children rolled down the grassy slope laughing. 孩子們笑著從草坡上滾下來。
scenery	*n.*	風景	The scenery along the Suhua Highway is breathtaking. 蘇花公路沿途的風景美得令人屏息。

wildlife	*n.*	野生動物	The park protects the wildlife that lives in the forest. 這座公園保護住在森林裡的野生動物。
twinkle	*v.*	閃爍	The lights of the city twinkled below us. 城市的燈光在我們下方閃爍。
owl	*n.*	貓頭鷹	An owl hooted somewhere in the dark forest. 一隻貓頭鷹在黑暗森林的某處鳴叫。
wilderness	*n.*	荒野	They spent a week camping in the wilderness without a phone. 他們在荒野露營了一週，沒有帶手機。
species	*n.*	物種	This species of butterfly is found only in Taiwan. 這種蝴蝶只在台灣才看得到。
meadow	*n.*	草地；牧草地	Cows were eating grass quietly in the meadow. 牛群在草地上安靜地吃草。
instinct	*n.*	本能；直覺	Birds fly south in winter by instinct. 鳥類憑本能在冬天飛往南方。
poisonous	*adj.*	有毒的	Do not touch that snake; it is poisonous. 不要碰那條蛇，牠有毒。

片語 Phrases

now and then	偶爾；不時	We still meet for coffee now and then. 我們偶爾還會見面喝咖啡。
be home to	是…的家；有…棲息	Taiwan is home to many kinds of butterflies. 台灣是許多種蝴蝶的家。
make the effort	付出努力	If you make the effort, you will see the difference. 如果你付出努力，你就會看到差別。

文法與句型 Grammar

S + V + as + adj./adv. + as + N

同等比較「和…一樣…」，as 與 as 中間放形容詞或副詞原級。文章第一段：Few places feel as far from the city as the Hehuanshan area；第二段：moths as large as a child's palm.

This lake is as beautiful as Sun Moon Lake.

這座湖和日月潭一樣美。

S + V + as long as + S + V

「只要…」，as long as 引導條件子句，表示主要子句的結果必須在此條件下才成立。文章第四段：they survive only as long as we leave them untamed.

You can borrow my bike as long as you return it by six.

只要你六點前還我，就可以借我的腳踏車。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。